STUDENT SUCCESS

Best Tips for School in 2021

School can be challenging, but these simple tips can help any student stay organized, study more effectively, and succeed this year.

By Student Life Helper Staff | January 8, 2021 | 12 minute read

Doing well in school takes effort, planning, and a positive attitude. Whether you are in middle school, high school, college, or another kind of program, good habits can make a big difference. Try the ideas below and choose the ones that work best for you.

> **School in 2021:** We are still living through a global pandemic, and much of school is still online. Students may be learning from home, attending video classes, or switching between online and in-person schedules. Remember that everyone is adjusting.

1. Take Good Notes

Taking notes can help you remember what your teacher says. Write down important facts, definitions, dates, and examples. Keep your notes neat so you can read them later. If your class is online, keep a notebook beside your computer and avoid opening unrelated websites while the teacher is speaking.

2. Study Your Notes

Do not wait until the night before a test to begin studying. Look over your notes regularly and highlight important ideas. You can make flash cards, rewrite information, or ask someone to quiz you. Studying a little at a time may help the information stay fresh in your mind.

3. Stay Organized

Use a planner or calendar to record assignments and due dates. Keep school papers in folders and give each class its own section. For online classes, create folders on your computer and use clear file names. Check your course website often so you do not miss announcements.

4. Find a Good Place to Work

Choose a place where you can concentrate. Try to keep the area clean and have your books, charger, paper, and pens nearby. If you share space with other people, let them know when you are attending class. Wearing headphones may help reduce distractions during online school.

5. Ask Questions

If you do not understand something, ask your teacher for help. You can raise your hand, send an email, visit office hours, or ask after class. Other students may have the same question. Asking for help shows that you want to learn and can prevent confusion later.

6. Take Breaks and Get Enough Sleep

It is hard to concentrate when you are tired. Try to sleep on a regular schedule and take short breaks during long study sessions. Stand up, stretch, drink water, or look away from the screen. During the pandemic, students may spend many hours on computers, so breaks are especially important.



A student takes handwritten notes while attending an online class from home in 2021.

Quick School Checklist

- Bring the right materials
- Write down assignments
- Review your notes
- Ask for help
- Get enough sleep

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